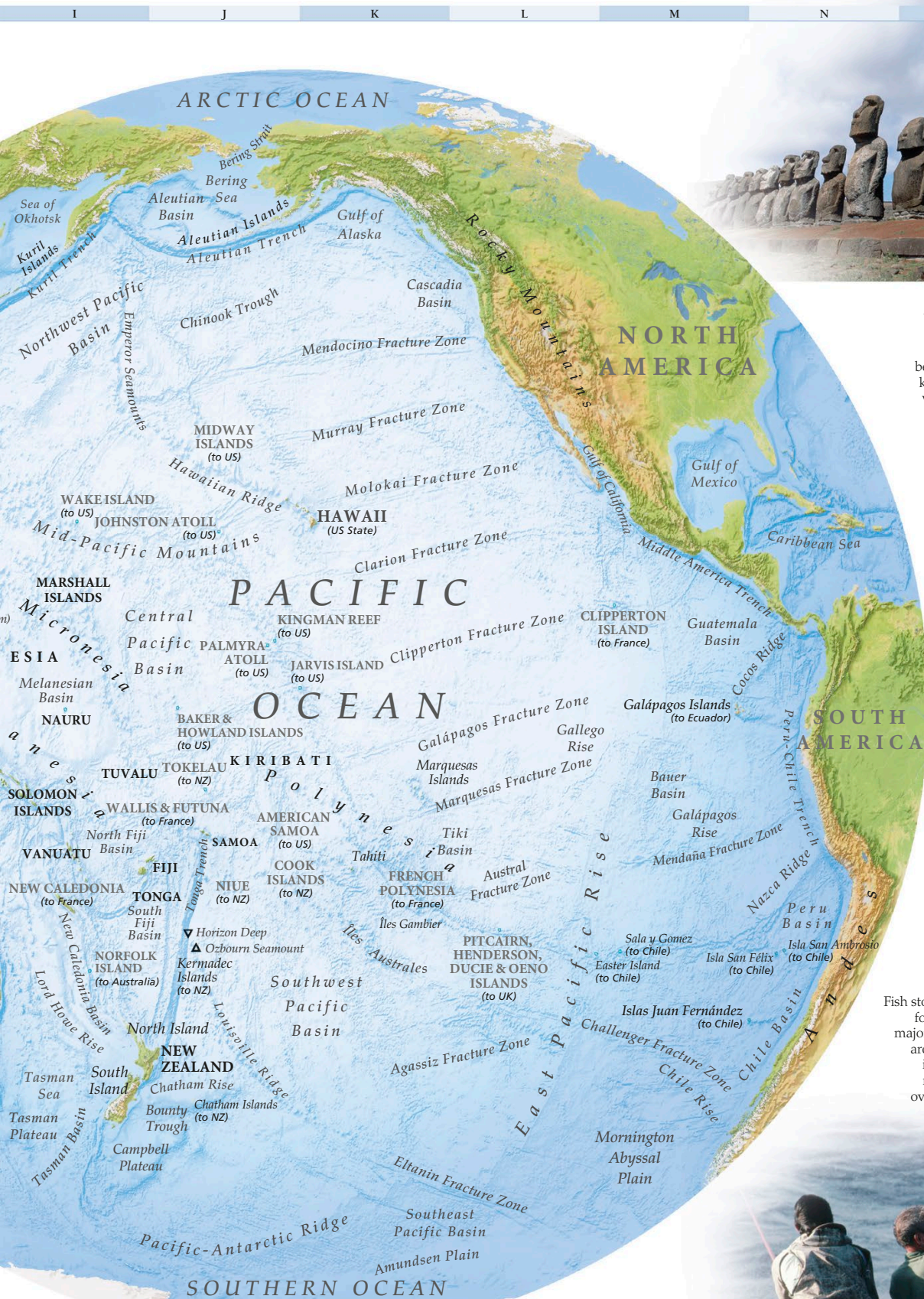
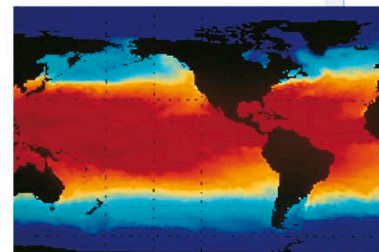




EASTER ISLAND
Easter Island, or Rapa Nui, in the Pacific lies more than 2,000 miles (3,218 km) from the nearest populated land. It is best known for the gigantic stone figures, known as Moai, which were carved from volcanic rock and erected facing the sea. It is thought that the people who built the statues were of Peruvian descent.



EL NIÑO
Every few years, winds off the South American coast weaken, causing an unusually warm ocean current, known as El Niño. This kills off plankton that provide food for fish such as anchovies. Scientists use heat-sensitive cameras to map ocean temperatures and keep track of El Niño. The warmest waters are shown in orange/red (above).

SOUTH PACIFIC FISH
Fish stocks in the south Pacific are an important food source for the island countries and a major source of employment. Migratory tuna are the most important fish. However, it is important that the industry is effectively managed to avoid the constant threat of overfishing and the collapse of fish stocks.

Tuna fishing needs to be carefully monitored.

